

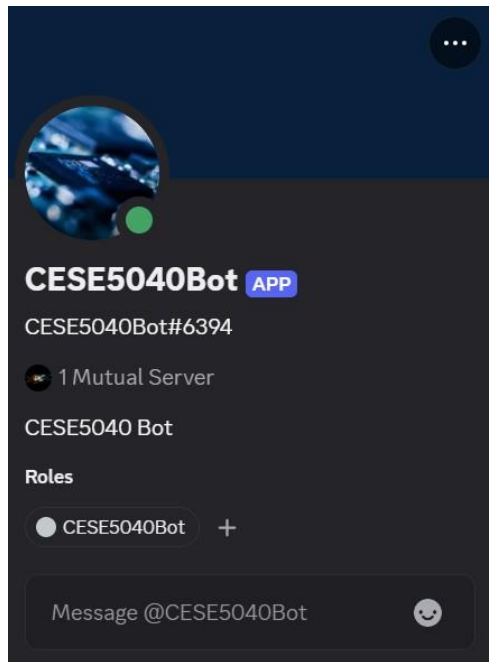
Lab Instructions – How to connect to AWS via Discord

Quick setup and access guide for your course AWS instance.

A. Provisioning Your AWS Instance via Discord

The lab infrastructure is managed through a specialized Discord bot. Follow these steps to claim and manage your virtual machine.

1. **Join the server:** Open the Discord invite link: <https://discord.gg/u4yZN22E>
2. **Locate the bot:** Find and directly message CESE5040Bot from the member list.



3. **Initialize your account:** Send the command \$hello.

```
$hello  
  
CESE5040Bot APP 16:54  
The administrator has not assigned an instance to you! Please  
message them
```

If you receive an error or a “not assigned” message, please contact [llandsmeer](#) to be manually added to the course roster.

Once you see the “assigned” confirmation, you may proceed.

```
$hello

CESE5040Bot APP 16:56
Congratulations! Instance with IP address [redacted] was assigned to you!
You can use the following commands with this bot:
$info : Get information about your instance and budget
$start : Start your instance
$stop : Stop your instance
```

4. **Check budget and instance details:** Use \$info to view your instance details, remaining budget, and current status.

```
$info

CESE5040Bot APP 16:56
Instance IP: [redacted]
Instance state: stopped
Budget: 16:00
Used time: 0:00
Time left this week: 16:00
```

Important

Budget Management: You are allocated 16 hours per week. The budget resets every Monday. If you exceed this limit, you will lose access until the next reset. Stop your instance whenever you are not actively working.

5. **Start the instance:** Use \$start to move your instance to the “running” state. Startup typically takes 1–3 minutes.

```
$start

CESE5040Bot APP 17:06
Instance is starting! You should be able to connect within a few minutes.
```

Check the status again: Run \$info again to verify that the instance is running and to retrieve your public IP address.

```
$info  
  
CESE5040Bot APP 17:07  
Instance IP:   
Instance state: running  
Budget: 16:00  
Used time: 0:01  
Time left this week: 15:59
```

6. **Stop the instance when finished:** Use `$stop` immediately after your session to conserve your weekly hours.

```
$stop  
  
CESE5040Bot APP 17:07  
Instance is stopping!
```

Caution

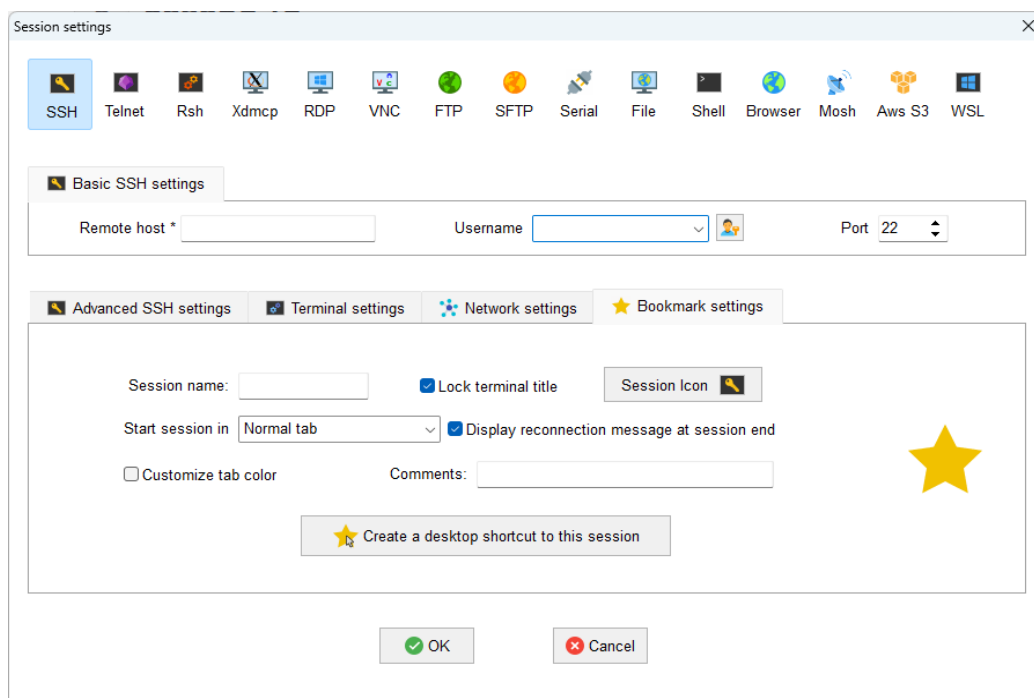
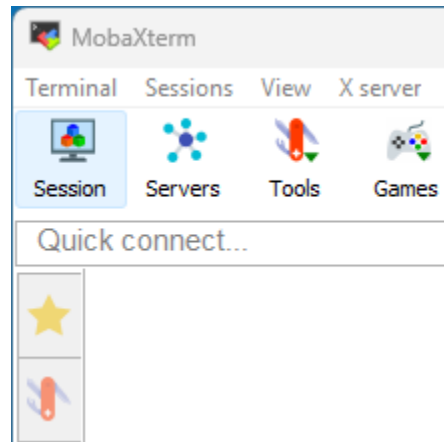
Data Persistence: While we make every effort to preserve data after the instance stops, you should back up important files to local storage or a cloud service.

Data recovery cannot be guaranteed in the event of system failure.

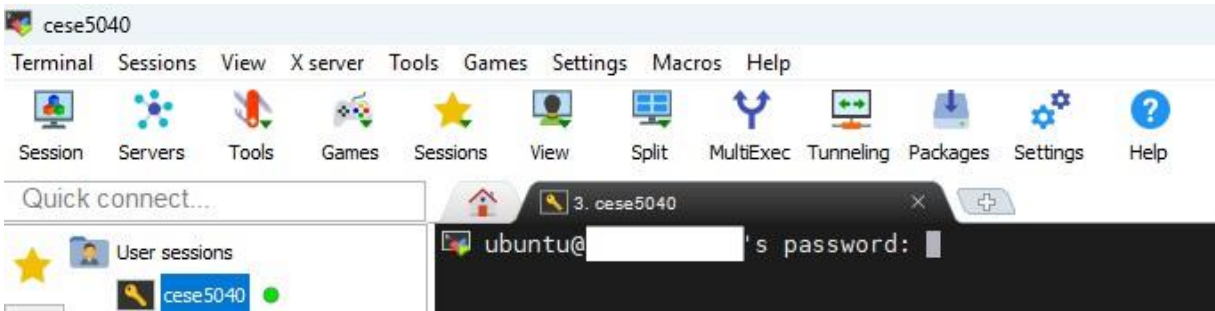
B. Connecting to Your AWS Instance

You can connect using the native ssh command available in Windows PowerShell/CMD, macOS, or Linux. For Windows users, MobaXterm is recommended because it includes an integrated SFTP file browser.

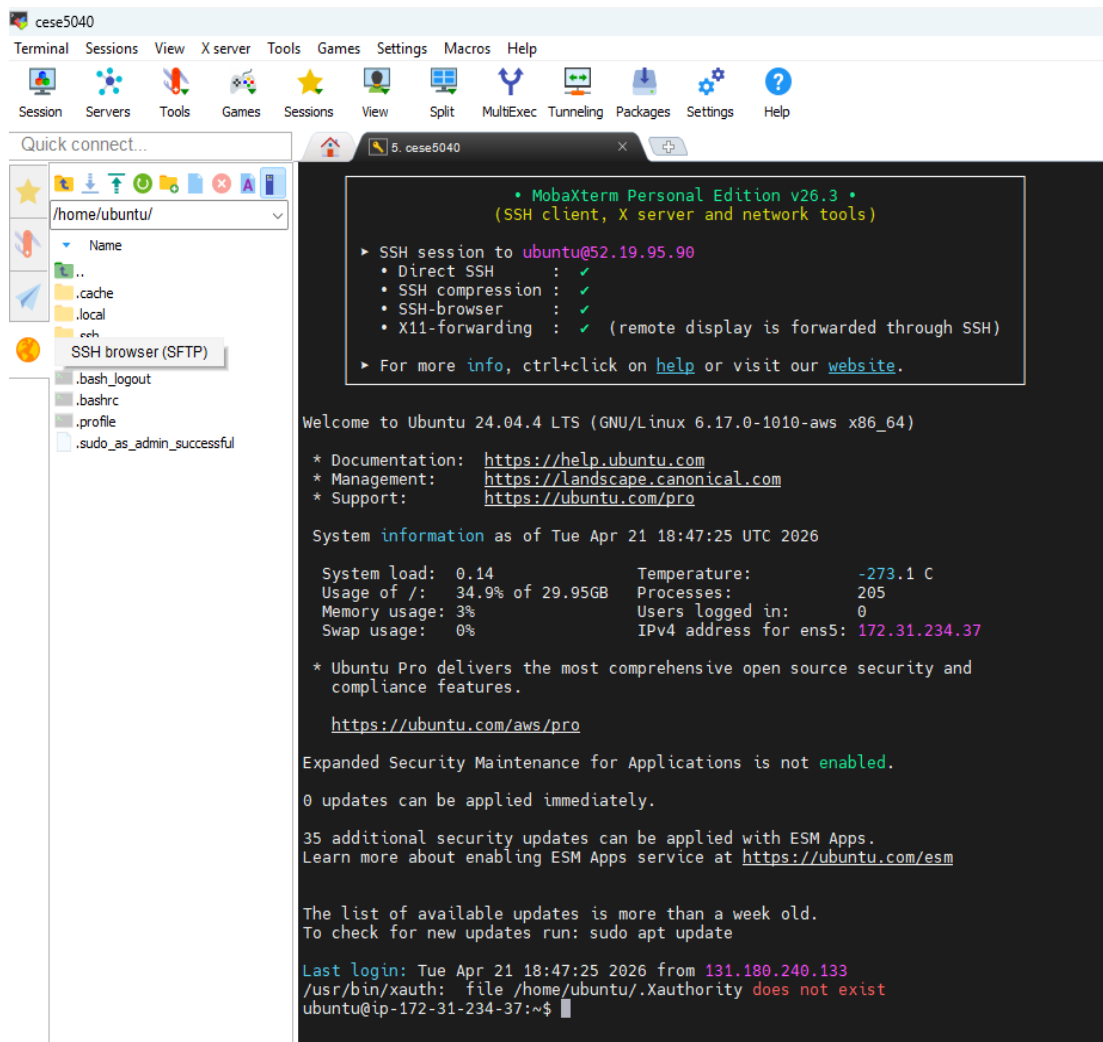
1. **Install MobaXterm:** Download the Home Edition from the official website.
2. **Configure the session:** Open MobaXterm, click **Session** → **SSH**. Enter the public IP address obtained via \$info as the remote host, and use ubuntu as the username.



3. **Authenticate:** Accept the host key warning on first connection. When prompted for a password, enter CESE5040TU. The cursor may remain stationary while you type; this is normal.
- 4.



5. **Transfer files:** Use the SFTP pane in MobaXterm to drag and drop files between your local machine and the server.



6. **Verify the environment:** The instance is preconfigured with Python 3.12 and the required lab packages. You can verify this with:

```
python3 --version
```

```
pip3 list
```

You are now ready to begin the lab exercises. **Remember to stop your instance when you are finished.**